

Zakiy T. Manigo

AI Product Engineer

New York, NY | +1 (908) 230-6948 | zakiymanigo@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/zakiymanigo

AI product engineer who ships model-backed features with constraints: grounding, cost and latency, failure UX, and safety. Applies existing models in production products.

EXPERIENCE

FITD

New York, NY

Founder and AI Product Engineer

2025 – Present

- Shipped Gemini 2.0 Flash in product for closet and brand labeling, a stylist grounded on wardrobe and weather, daily colors and styles, and Vertex virtual try-on via a Cloud Function proxy so the mobile client never embeds the key.
- Built community bots (Gemini, Imagen, Veo) with human approval, quotas, moderation, and a kill switch. Recommendation scoring from likes, onboarding, and implicit signals on a production SwiftUI app and Firebase / GCP backend.

BariAccess (TREI)

New York, NY / Remote

Software Engineer (one of two primary engineers)

Jun 2025 – Present

- Productized a guarded Azure OpenAI assistant on a GLP-1 / metabolic-care platform: voice and text, fail-closed public surfaces, and patient-language rules so the model cannot invent a clinical baseline. Staging on Azure with Key Vault-held secrets.

FitGenius

Remote

Founding Technical Partner

May 2026 – Sep 2026

- Applied Gemini on Vertex AI to fitness: catalog-constrained coach, JSON plans, food estimates, and client / server context parity. GPS, health samples, and photos stripped from model payloads. Hybrid: LLM features plus deterministic overload, pace, and Fit Score engines.

Local AI

New York, NY

Product Engineer

2026

- Offline Windows desktop app (Tauri 2, React, Rust): local GGUF via llama.cpp, chat, model library, documents and retrieval-augmented generation, NSIS installer. UI never calls cloud inference APIs.

LaunchPage Studios

New York, NY / New Jersey

Founding Engineer

Oct 2025 – Present

- Shipped TaxTacker, Alex Road Service, and Insightful Care as full products. Prior: Database Engineer Intern, City of Elizabeth, May 2024 – Sep 2024.

EDUCATION

Columbia University

New York, NY

Bachelor of Science, Computer Engineering

May 2025

Combined Plan with St. Lawrence University. Bachelor of Arts, Mathematics, May 2023. Exchange: James Cook University, Townsville, QLD, 2022.

SKILLS

AI product: Gemini, Vertex AI, Azure OpenAI, llama.cpp / GGUF, prompt packs, kill switches, grounding

Build: TypeScript, Swift, React, Expo, Fastify, Firebase / GCP, Azure, Rust / Tauri